

Kayla Yi

Human Factors Engineer | UX/UI Researcher

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PROFESSIONAL OVERVIEW

Human Factors Engineer and UX/UI Researcher with 4+ years leading end-to-end user research to inform designs of complex, safety-critical systems in both military and commercial domains. Skilled in both qualitative and quantitative research methods as well as interfacing with cross-functional teams including UX designers, engineers and program stakeholders to help build tools that support users operating high consequence, high complexity digital systems safely and effectively. Experience working in the domain of surface and undersea warfare, unmanned and autonomous vehicles, and command and control.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Human Factors Engineer | Pacific Science & Engineering Group, San Diego, CA MAY 2022 – PRESENT

- Led user engagements including observations, focus groups and workshops to collect real-world user insights to evaluate the system and inform future program strategy
- Translated hundreds of qualitative observations and user feedback into actionable Human Centered Integration recommendations resulting in improved usability of the product year over year
- Authored technical documentation including study protocols, evaluation reports, findings summaries, user requirements, workflows and design recommendations to support product development.
- Developed and deployed surveys to collect metrics on digital products such as usability, utility and user satisfaction as well as workload (NASA-TLX) to evaluate program development over time.

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Strategy & Operations Coordinator | Inspire Diagnostics, Mountain View, CA SEP 2021 – JAN 2022

- Identified a critical workflow bottleneck that was increasing the processing and reporting time for thousands of COVID-19 test samples, improved sample handover procedures and reduced result turnaround time by an average of 4 hours during the high of the pandemic
- Developed standardized training materials and workflow documentation aligned with CDC guidance to improve consistency, quality, and regulatory compliance across diagnostic testing operations collecting over 20,000 samples per day.

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Scientific Literature Reviewer (Co-Op) | Corbion, Lenexa, KS MAY 2021 – SEP 2021

- Reviewed technical documentation to inform product strategy and delivered strategic recommendations to a cross-functional team of R&D, regulatory, business, and product stakeholders.

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Lab Systems Engineer (Quality, Safety and Reliability) | Exxon Mobil, Kansas City, KS JUL 2017 – MAY 2021

- Led structured investigations using Root Cause Analysis (RCA) and Failure Modes and Effects Analysis (FMEA) to identify process failures and implement corrective actions that reduced significant safety incidents by 20%.

EDUCATION

Master of Industrial and Systems Engineering | Auburn University, Auburn, AL

Graduated: 2022

Master of Business Administration | Auburn University, Auburn, AL

Graduated: 2022

Bachelor of Science - Molecular Biology | University of Kansas, Lawrence, KS.

Graduated: 2017